

PATHWAYS · READING

What makes a strong CV

Simplified English (B1) version

A CV is a short document about you. It tells people who you are and what you can do. Its job is to make the reader want to know more about you. The reader is often busy and looks at it for only a short time. So a good CV is clear and easy to read. It does not list everything. It shows the most important things for one job or opportunity.

Show results, not only tasks

Many people only write their tasks. It is stronger to show results. For example, do not just write "I looked after the shop". Write "I ran a small shop alone at weekends. I kept the money records and served fifty people a day." This shows what you can really do. When you can, show what happened because of your work: how many, how well, what changed.

You have more experience than you think

People often forget important experience. Unpaid work counts. Helping your family counts. Volunteering counts. Speaking more than one language counts. For example: caring for younger children, translating for your family, or helping at a community event. These show your skills. If you do not write them, the reader cannot know about them.

Clear and honest

Use a clear order: your contact details, a short summary, your education, your experience, your skills, and your references. Keep it short. Be honest. CV rules are different in different countries. The right length, and whether to add a photo, can change. Check what is normal where you apply.

A CV is never finished

Change your CV for each opportunity. Show the experience that fits best. Add new things when you learn or achieve something. The CV you write today is a start, not the end.